

CS Project Initiation

Project initiation outlines the goal of the project; the potential benefits to the society, the stakeholders, the outputs, estimates of the resources and time required, and discusses the major risks to the project's success. This document will be used to gain approval from the senior management team to proceed to the next step of the process. The project leader will expand this document into a project plan and/or a business plan after it is approved. Descriptions are included at the end of the document.

Project name or title:

PAB-IT: ICT Skills & Competencies Definition
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Background on the project:

In June 2010 the PAB IT committee presented a White Paper which outlined several fields within IT and listed some "artifacts" needed as a foundation for any profession. Among the required artifacts is a definition of skills and competency (for any of the given fields in IT).

As documented in the PAB White Paper the skills and competencies are linked to other artifacts needed to help establish the foundation for a true profession. Skills and competencies can be viewed as input to the following:

- Criteria for certifications of professionals
- Skills Assessment and career guidance tools for professional development
- Planning of training
- Job descriptions

At present IEEE-CS has not established a plan with respect to a professional certification in IT (general or specific to any one field). In 2011 it is hoped that a specific plan be completed with respect to possible IEEE-CS certifications in IT. This focus on certification would be distinct from work on skills and competencies, but must be coordinated.

At present various skills and certification scheme exist for ICT (e.g. SFIA and ICTC). There are perhaps other skills and competency models in non-English speaking domains not yet evaluated by the PAB-IT committee. While the IEEE-CS may choose to adopt or reference one or more of these existing external models, there may be constraints and limitations involved, depending upon the nature of the organization owning the external model. It might also be possible for IEEE-CS to attempt to influence and improve such an external model. And finally, another possibility might be that IEEE-CS attempts to facilitate the development of a new multi-lateral consensus on ICT skills and competencies.

In 2011, the intent is to:

- complete a internal initial evaluation of external existing skills and competency definitions (e.g. SFIA and OSPM);
- to evaluate the alignment of PAB-IT model for the IT sub-professions with respect to the job role and professional categories put forth by the external models;;
- To revise the PAB-IT model for the IT sub-professions if needed in order to align with external models, or to prepare a summary of the most significant differences;
- Once agreement on the alignment (and differences) with external models is established by PAB-IT, to provide a preliminary report for review and comment by PAB; IAB; and senior CS leadership. This report will clearly position the PAB-IT model for each of the identified sub-professions, but it will allow leaders within the CS to make informed judgements about our alignment with external models.

- Once feedback has been obtained from within the IEEE CS concerning alignment of our PAB-IT professional model with external models, the PAB-IT will attempt to hold meetings with various external bodies to discuss the high level model of the IT profession. This round of meetings may include both organizations who are offering various external models (say of job roles and skills, such as SFIA and OSPM) as well as with IT professional societies who are using and applying such models (e.g. BCS, ACS, CEPIS).
- After the initial meeting(s) held to review the broad model of the IT profession(s), separate meetings should be convened beginning in late 2011 or in 2012 to discuss job roles, skills and competency in greater detail. This will be a series of meetings or workshops, organized by sub-profession, so that the scope can be more focused within a sub-profession, and so that additional experts /groups in the respective sub-professions (e.g. IT Services Management) can be invited.
- recommend a strategy for the IEEE-CS which will result in the establishment of some ICT skills and competency framework (either newly developed, adopted or adapted);

While planning and considering the three sub-professions the PAB-IT committee will keep in mind all aspects of the model of a profession. That is PAB-IT will be aware of not only the job roles and skills; but relate these to education and formation; continuing professional development; professional standards of practice; and Bodies of Knowledge.

Project goal:

Note that in order to facilitate this evaluation, external engagement, and possible alignment with external existing models, PAB-IT will consider:

- Holding IEEE-CS internal briefings and workshops with outside experts such as Mr. Bob Hart (Manager Professional Stds for ACS, Chair of Standards Committee for IP3);
- Holding informational meetings with external organizations in order to understand their respective detailed skills and competency models;
- Holding informational meetings with external organizations in order to determine the extent to which IEEE-CS may become involved (e.g. suggesting modifications, licensing, adaptation of the original model, etc);
- Holding discussions with external organizations to gauge whether there is the possibility of multiple organizations working together, moving toward a consensus standard for skills and competency definition in ICT;

Development of these recommendations and strategy must follow. If IEEE-CS' preferred course of action in this area is reliant upon one or more external standard(s), there must be engagement of some kind with at least the organization(s) responsible for the external standard(s).

After the information gathering phase, PAB-IT will:

- Have a clear model of skills and competencies it wishes to use as a base for the profession and for its own professional activities planning in IT;
- Identified any external (skills and competency) model(s) it may wish to adopt or reference, and identified any desired modifications;
- Identified based upon the above, the next steps which can or should be taken with respect to external organizations.

PAB-IT will recommend engagement strategy with external organizations, as appropriate for the desired relationships. The recommended engagement strategy may involve establishment of technical liaisons (in the case of a standards body managing only a skills and competency standard). However the recommendations for engagement may include the establishment of relationships with organizations at a higher level (such as partnerships with individual professional societies and IP3).

Re-stating the above in terms of three levels of possible outcomes:

Minimal:

- PAB-IT high level analysis of external models, including desired changes or differences with respect to the PAB-IT model of the sub-professions.
- PAB-IT SWOT analysis indicating recommendations for possible relationships with external organizations (based primarily on standard for skills & competency);
- The development of each PAB-IT sub-profession proceeds but with awareness of the overlap or gaps with respect to significant external models.

Full:

- Identification and selection of an existing external standard in skills and competency (perhaps in each sub-profession or specialty)
- Establishment of a proper relationship / liaison with one or more ICT standards organizations or other orgs (e.g. other professional societies, sector specific or technology specific organizations) which permit PAB-IT and IEEE CS to utilize and influence the standard in an ongoing basis;
- Establish PAB-IT internal working group to handle ongoing work and relationships in skills and competency standards;
- Document and disseminate PAB-IT and IEEE-CS policy with respect to skills and competency definition (perhaps within context of PAB-IT decisions with respect to Syllabus, Certification, or other elements of the profession);

Exceptional:

- Hold external workshops or summits with multiple organizations involved in ICT skills and competency definition, work toward some commonality and consensus;
- Hold workshops and presentations to obtain feedback specifically for the chosen PAB-IT skills and competency model.

Measurable benefits:

This project will in the short term provide an analysis of skills and competencies in the three major ICT fields upon which PAB-IT is focused. This means that PAB-IT will ensure there will be no inconsistency between (our desired definition of) skills and competencies and our plans with respect to other foundational artifacts needed to establish a solid profession of IT.

Such analysis will also prepare the basis for IEEE CS products and services. Skills and competency definitions will allow us to lay the ground work for self assesment instruments, certification, training

and job definitions.

Project manager:

Staff: TBA; Volunteer: TBA

Volunteer champions:

PAB-IT, sub-profession leaders in PAB-IT, Chair of PAB

Stakeholders:

Content experts:

Key staff needed to work on the project: (Check as many as apply)

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|---|--|
| ☒ Finance and accounting | ☒ Advertising |
| ☒ Customer service | ☒ Magazines |
| ☐ Tokyo office | ☒ Transactions |
| ☒ Information technology and services | ☐ Proceedings |
| ☒ Electronic products and services | ☒ Volunteer services and conferences |
| ☒ Membership & circulation | ☒ Certification & training |

Key volunteers needed to work on the project:

Frank Ferrante & EPSC, David Grier, John Walz, Sorel Reisman

People who will want to be informed:

Business partner/sponsor:

None

Interdependencies or related CS projects:

Resources required:

	2011	Year 2	Year 3
Budget \$	\$	TBD	TBD
Exempt staff hours (estimate the hours that will be committed to the project)		TBD	TBD
Non-exempt staff hours	TBD	TBD	TBD
Volunteer hours (estimate the volunteer effort or commitment to the project in terms of hours)		TBD	TBD
Technology (any additional hardware, software or capital required to complete the project.)		TBD	TBD

Covered in an existing budget or needs new funds:

New funds, new or redirected staff needed

Timeline:**Minimal:****Full:****Exceptional:****Major risks:****Minimising the risks:**

Categorization: Identify the IEEE CS strategic goal or operational activity that this project addresses.

X Electronic future (on-line information and tools needed to deliver said info):

☐ Activity assessment (evaluate existing programs, products, and services):

X Nimbleness (quick response times for new ideas and services, quick decision-making, update PPM to reduce red tape, improve volunteer recognition, cooperation with other IEEE entities, actions/changes to Institute or other society programs, services, policies):

☐ Value proposition (adds value to membership, improves services, attracts new members, virtual communities/portals):

X Operations (CS or IEEE operations)

CS board: Identify the board (or committee) with which the project is associated

Priority ranking for the project from the board which sponsored it:**Requester:**

Name of requester(s)	Paul Joannou, Vice President Professional Activities
Specify the staff contact for the request	
Specify the volunteer contact for the request	
Email contact(s):	

Date requested:

17 February 2011

Project Initiation Descriptions -- for 2010 projects, please send to Angela Burgess

Background on the project: The circumstances and events surrounding this project or leading up to this request. How did we get where we are?

Project goal: Clearly state the purpose of the project; the what, where, when, and how the project will improve or change the CS including the products and services provided as part of the project.

Measurable benefits: Description of quantifiable, targeted benefits and potential benefits to be derived from doing this project (Examples — increased productivity, operational efficiencies, differentiate CS from competition, better or additional member services, increased membership, increase revenue, etc.)

Project manager: The project leader or project owner builds the project work plan, the budget and identifies the resources for the project.

Volunteer champion: List the volunteer(s) proposing the project, or championing it

Stakeholders: The people who have a vested interest in the outcome of the project, are involved in, or may be affected by project activities.

Content experts: The people who have the information needed to complete the project.

Key staff needed for the project: (Check as many as apply) People who will complete the work for the project. For example, a new publication launch will include magazines or transactions staff but will also involve electronic products staff for a web page, membership and circulation staff for marketing, a survey involves research, the pro forma budget for the business plan needs finance and accounting staff.

Key volunteers needed for the project: List volunteers who will work on the project.

Informed: The people who want to be informed during the project and be given regular progress reports.

Business partner/sponsor: Will the society have any co-sponsor or business partners that will have input to this project?

Interdependencies or related CS projects: List any projects that are dependent on this initiative or projects upon which this initiative is dependent.

Resources required: Estimate the resources (financial, staff time, volunteer time and technology) required to complete the project.

Covered in an existing budget or needs new funds: Explain how the project will be funded, whether it is covered under an existing budget, can be covered by existing Board funds and/or needs new funds.

Timeline: State the time period in which the project will be completed with a timeline including the start date, end date, and major milestones with dates.

Major risks: What are the barriers to achieving project success (i.e. the major risks)? What are the consequences if the project is not undertaken?

Minimizing the risks: What steps will be undertaken to minimize these major risks to the success of the project?

Categorization: Identify the strategic goal or operational activity that this project addresses.

CS board: Identify the board (or committee) with which the project is associated

Priority ranking from the board sponsoring the project: Rank on a three point scale whether the board feels the project is of high, medium or low priority to the Computer Society

Requester: Identify the origin of the project request or the person (s) wanting the society to launch this project.

Date requested: (Today's date or the date the project was requested)